

So, as an alternative I'm going to give you the ultimate rewards program, one that's available to you right now.

You don't have to bother playing the rewards point shuffle. You don't have to worry about innocently missing a repayment and being slugged with back interest for the month. You don't get hit with a hefty annual fee.

So what is this platinum-titanium rewards program?

It's you modelling good habits for your kids.

They'll grow up knowing Mum and Dad don't do credit cards.

They'll grow up watching their parents pay their own way, with THEIR OWN MONEY.

They'll grow up knowing that their parents are powerful money managers.

You'll make them see that not having a credit card is a *reverse status symbol*: you're so smart you don't need one.

'In our family, we *earn* interest, we don't pay it.'

Now that is the ultimate reward.

Everything you wanted to know about credit cards in one and a bit pages

Hang on, how can I blend my credit card? I don't have one!

Well, I'm not going to tell you to lie to your kids, but I did. I used an old Qantas Frequent Flyer card, and the kids had no idea. And I know that because when Gran came over, they grabbed her wallet out of her bag and headed to the blender. When you're three, Gran's credit card looks awfully similar to her driver's licence.

'NOOOOO!' says Gran.

'Gran, credit cards are bad, they cost you too much money,' says my oldest.